

tion policy”: go to **Start > Run**, type “Secpol.msc”, and hit [Enter]. Right-click on Software Restriction Policies and select Create New Policy. Expand SRP, right-click on Addition Rules, and select “New Path Rule...” Enter the path of the menacing program and set the security level to Disallowed. Click OK. Program gone!

Alignment Angst

Q I recently replaced the ink cartridges on my HP PSC 950 MFD, and ever since, it won't copy. When I run the alignment routine from the printer's front panel, the alignment page prints, but without the checkmarks that indicate the printer passed the alignment tests. Then I get the message “Alignment Failed Please Try Again,” which eventually changes to “Press Enter To Align Cartridges.” I can still print from the PC, but I can't copy from the front panel.

Vilas Seth

A You can run into a problem aligning print heads on almost any inkjet printer or MFD. Fortunately, the problem is usually with the paper or cartridges, not the printer itself. A quick fix is to first skip the alignment. With the PSC 950, you can do this by holding down [Enter] and pressing Setup. (You can find a list of equivalent combinations for other HP models at http://h10025.www1.hp.com/ewfrf/wc/genericDocument?cc=us&docname=bpu00657&lc=en&jumpid=reg_R1002_USEN (or <http://snipurl.com/qnadec1>.) Then, check the paper. If there's anything printed on the page, or if it's any colour but white, or if its brightness level—which should be indicated on the package—isn't at least 85, you can't use it for alignment.

If the problem isn't the paper, it's almost certainly the cartridges, which could be low on ink (if you replaced only one cartridge), defective, suffering from clogged nozzles, or past their shelf life. HP cartridges include a use-by date on the box. The dates tend to be conservative, but if the deadline is long since past, the cartridge could be all but useless.

Run the cartridge-cleaning routine, and then try aligning the cartridges again. If the problem was with clogged nozzles, the cleaning routine might fix it. If it doesn't, try cleaning the cartridges and the contacts in the printer. HP gives a step-by-step explanation for how to do this at http://h10025.www1.hp.com/ewfrf/wc/genericDocument?lc=en&cc=us&jumpid=reg_R1002_USEN&dlc=en&docname=bpu02176#bpu02176_doc (or <http://snipurl.com/qnadec2>).

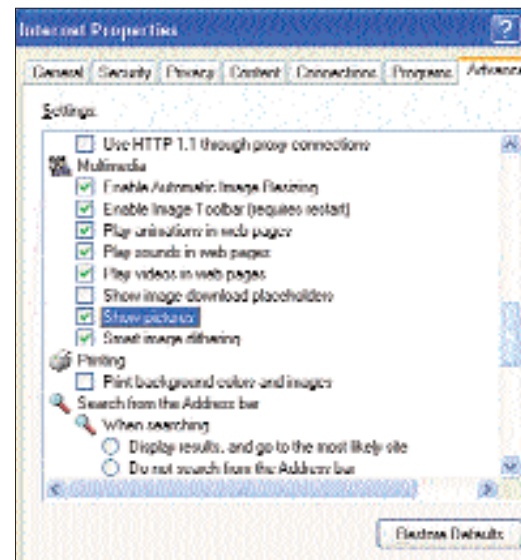
Once you've cleaned the cartridges, try the alignment routine again. If it still fails, you might want to try a new set of cartridges. Or, you might want to bypass the alignment and use up the ink in the current cartridges before getting new ones.

A Picture Is Worth...

Q When I open any Web page in Internet Explorer, none of the pictures, ads or buttons are visible. All I get is an outline of where they would normally

show, with three little shapes in the top-left corner of each box.

Manoj Rajput



Choose to show pictures in Internet Explorer

A This problem is almost always caused after installation of buggy software. To resolve the problem, go to **Control Panel > Internet Options**. Choose the Advanced tab. Scroll down to the Multimedia section. Check the Show Pictures box. Also check the Show Image Download Placeholders box. Click OK. IE should be fine now.

We Can Work It Out

Q I upgraded my Dell Dimension 8200 from Windows 2000 to XP Pro using Dell's Windows XP Pro Upgrade CD. Now, when I power it up, it makes a sound, and the following messages appear: “Invalid boot.INI file” and “booting from C:\winnt\boot.” Then it boots up. Occasionally it fails to boot, but on my second attempt, it has been booting up with the same error message. What's up?

Mani Iyer

A The boot.ini file contains information the boot loader needs, including which drive Windows has been installed on. There is also a backup of the boot.ini file, which can be used by the OS in case of a crash. The boot.ini file is just a text file. Incorrectly editing boot.ini, though, can result in an inoperable PC, so we'll tell you the easier way to get rid of the error message. You'll need to have the original Windows CD. Boot from the CD and start the Recovery Console by pressing [R] when asked. If you have more than one OS—for example, if you're dual-booting Windows XP 32-bit and Windows XP 64-bit—you'll be asked which one you want to recover. Pick the one you want. Then you'll see something like a DOS prompt. Type in “bootcfg /rebuild”.

When you enter this command, you receive a message that says:

The Windows installation scan was successful.